

Treehouse to the Moon

Putting it on the App Store

Steps for your Mac · Part 2: App Store listing text

Before you start: the project is on GitHub at `github.com/Dotsong/Treehouse-to-the-Moon`. Everything below happens in its `app` folder.

Remember: replace `[your contact email]` in `privacy.html` before submitting, and turn on GitHub Pages so the privacy policy has a web address.

This folder turns the game into an iPhone and iPad app with Capacitor. The app shows the game full-screen in a built-in web view, with three.js and the fonts bundled inside, so it works without an internet connection.

You'll need:

- **A Mac** with **Xcode** (free from the Mac App Store).
- **Node.js** (the LTS version from nodejs.org).
- An **Apple Developer Program** membership. It's a yearly fee; check developer.apple.com for the current price.

Steps 1–4 happen once. After that, updating the app is step 8.

1. Get the project onto your Mac

```
git clone https://github.com/Dotsong/Treehouse-to-the-Moon.git
cd Treehouse-to-the-Moon/app
npm install
```

2. Build the offline game and create the iOS project

```
npm run build        # copies ../index.html into www/, pointed at the bundled files
npx cap add ios      # creates the ios/ Xcode project (one time only)
npm run ios          # syncs the game into the project and opens Xcode
```

If `npx cap add ios` asks for CocoaPods, install it with `brew install cocoapods` (or `sudo gem install cocoapods`) and run the command again.

Commit the new `ios/` folder to the repo, so the Xcode settings below are saved.

3. Set up the app in Xcode

In the left sidebar, click **App** (the blue project icon), then the **App** target:

- **Signing & Capabilities**
  - **Team:** choose your Apple Developer account.
  - **Bundle Identifier:** `com.dotsong.treehousetothemoon`, or your own reverse-domain ID. If you change it, change `appId` in `capacitor.config.json` to match.
- **General**
  - **Display Name:** Treehouse to the Moon.
  - **Supported Destinations:** iPhone and iPad.
  - **Device Orientation:** leave all orientations on. The game adapts to any shape, and iPad multitasking needs them.
  - **Version** 1.0.0, **Build** 1.
- **Info** (or `ios/App/App/Info.plist`): add
  - `Status bar is initially hidden` = `YES`
  - `View controller-based status bar appearance` = `NO`
- **Keep the screen awake during the flight.** The game is meant to be watched without touching it, so stop iPads from dimming and locking mid-trip. Open `ios/App/App/AppDelegate.swift` and add one line inside `application(_:didFinishLaunchingWithOptions:)`, before `return true`:

```
UIApplication.shared.isIdleTimerDisabled = true
```

4. App icon and launch screen

- **Icon:** open `ios/App/App/Assets.xcassets`, then **AppIcon**. Drag `icon/AppIcon-1024.png` from this folder into the 1024×1024 slot. Recent Xcode versions make every other size from it.
- **Launch screen:** open `ios/App/App/Base.lproj/LaunchScreen.storyboard`, select the view, and set its **Background** color to **#0E0D2A** (the game's night blue). That way the app doesn't flash white while it starts.

5. Try it

- Pick an **iPad simulator** at the top of Xcode and press **Run** (▶).
- Then plug in a real iPad or iPhone, pick it as the destination, and run it there too. Check:
  - **Sound:** music starts on the first tap, and it plays with the mute switch on.
  - **No zooming:** double-tapping and pinching don't zoom the page; pinching the scene zooms the camera.
  - **Offline:** turn on **Airplane Mode** and relaunch. Everything should still work.
  - **Screen stays on:** the screen doesn't lock during a long flight.

6. Create the app in App Store Connect

At appstoreconnect.apple.com, go to **Apps**, then **+** and **New App**:

- **Platform:** iOS. **Name:** Treehouse to the Moon. **Bundle ID:** the one from step 3. **SKU:** anything unique, for example `treehouse-moon-1`.
- Fill in the listing from `APP_STORE_LISTING.md`: subtitle, description, keywords and categories.
- **Privacy Policy URL:** turn on GitHub Pages for the repo (**Settings** → **Pages** → branch `main`, folder `/`). The policy will then be at `https://dotsong.github.io/Treehouse-to-the-Moon/privacy.html`. **First, replace the contact placeholder in `privacy.html` with a real email address.**
- **App Privacy:** answer **"Data Not Collected"**. The game has no accounts, ads, analytics or tracking. The only thing it saves is which facts you've found, and that stays on the device.
- **Age rating:** answer **None** to everything, which gives **4+**.
- **Kids category (optional):** listing it under **Kids** (age band 6–8 suits it) adds extra review checks: no ads, no third-party analytics, and a grown-up check before any outside link. The game already meets those, since it has no outside links at all.
- **Screenshots:** in the simulator, use **File** → **Save Screen** (or ⌘S) on the largest iPhone and the largest iPad that App Store Connect asks for. Good moments are the opening card, liftoff, the cloud bank, space, the Moon with Lumi, and dinner at home.

7. Upload and submit

1. In Xcode, set the destination to **Any iOS Device (arm64)**.
2. **Product** → **Archive.**
3. In the Organizer window, choose **Distribute App**, then **App Store Connect**, then **Upload**.
4. After a few minutes the build appears in App Store Connect. Try it yourself first through **TestFlight** if you like.
5. On the app's version page, pick the build and press **Add for Review**, then **Submit**.

Apple's review usually takes a day or two. If they ask questions, answer in App Store Connect.

8. Updating the app later

Whenever `index.html` changes:

```
cd app
npm run sync         # rebuilds www/ and copies it into the iOS project
npx cap open ios
```

Then bump the **Build** number (and the **Version**, for a visible update), archive, and upload as in step 7.

What's in this folder

File	What it is
`package.json`	Capacitor dependencies and the `build` / `sync` / `ios` commands
`capacitor.config.json`	App ID, name, background color, web-view settings
`vendor-files/`	three.js r128 and the three fonts, with their licenses (MIT and SIL OFL)
`www/`	The built, offline game, regenerated by `npm run build` (don't edit it by hand)
`icon/`	`AppIcon-1024.png` and the `icon.svg` it was drawn from
`APP_STORE_LISTING.md`	Ready-to-paste App Store text

App Store listing

Ready to paste into App Store Connect. The character counts fit Apple's limits.

Name (30 max)

Treehouse to the Moon

Subtitle (30 max)

A cozy balloon trip for kids

Promotional text (170 max)

Two sisters tie fifty balloons to their treehouse and float all the way to the Moon, and back home in time for spaghetti. No rush, no scores, just a dreamy trip.

Description

Every night, June and her little sister Pip say goodnight to the Moon from their treehouse. Tonight, they're going to visit it.

Treehouse to the Moon is a slow, dreamy 3D adventure with nothing to beat and nowhere to hurry. Run the pre-flight checklist with the girls, count down to liftoff, and watch their balloon-lifted treehouse drift up past birds and airplanes, through a big fluffy cloud, and out into space.

ON THE WAY UP • Float over farms, forests, rivers, a little town and a twinkling city • Rise through every layer of the sky, from the clouds to outer space • Wave at friendly UFOs and make wishes on shooting stars

ON THE MOON • Climb down the rope ladder and leave the first footprints • Build moon castles and rock towers, draw in the dust, and make moon angels • Play extra-long, low-gravity hopscotch • Collect shiny moon rocks for a souvenir bucket • Meet Lumi, a real moon girl who has been hiding behind a boulder

HOME FOR DINNER • Float home under the stars as the town lights come on • Mom and Dad are waiting on the lawn with a lantern, and the spaghetti is almost ready

A FACT BOOK TO FILL Little book tags float over things along the way. Tap one to read a kid-friendly science fact about balloons, clouds, the layers of the atmosphere, stars, the Moon and more. There are 27 to collect.

MADE FOR CALM • Gentle music made just for the trip • Funny, sweet conversations between the sisters • Pause any time • No ads, no in-app purchases, no accounts, and no data collected • Works with no

internet connection

Keywords (100 max, comma-separated, no spaces)

moon,space,balloons,bedtime,calm,cozy,story,stars,science,facts,kids,relaxing,astronaut,sisters

Categories

- **Primary:** Games, with the **Family** and **Educational** subcategories
- **Secondary:** Education

Age rating

4+ (answer "None" to every content question)

App Privacy

Data Not Collected

Support URL

https://github.com/Dotsong/Treehouse-to-the-Moon

Privacy Policy URL

https://dotsong.github.io/Treehouse-to-the-Moon/privacy.html (after GitHub Pages is turned on)

What's New (version 1.0)

The first trip to the Moon! Float up with June and Pip, meet Lumi, and make it home for dinner.